

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1025

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor Dr. Stacey Floyd-Thomas on her astute service to the Tennessee Ethics Commission.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize those dedicated citizens who have excelled in their field, bringing great pride to this State; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Dr. Stacey Floyd-Thomas, who has dedicated years of excellence to her community and this State as an integral part of the Tennessee Ethics Commission; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Stacey Floyd-Thomas currently serves with acumen and alacrity as the E. Rhodes and Leona B. Carpenter Professor of Ethics and Society at Vanderbilt University Divinity School, Executive Director of the Society of Christian Ethics and the Black Religious Scholars Group, and co-founder of the Society for the Study of Race, Ethnicity, and Religion; and

WHEREAS, her research and teaching interests lie at the intersection of ethics, feminist and womanist studies, Black Church studies, critical pedagogy, critical race theory, and postcolonial studies, with an overall approach to the study of Christian social ethics and moral agency, cultural memory, ethical responsibility, and social justice; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Stacey Floyd-Thomas's research draws upon sociohistorical and liberation methods, and her work in Christian social ethics focuses on race, gender, and class, as well as the challenges of religious pluralism, social justice, and the political world; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Floyd-Thomas is the author of several publications, including *Mining the Motherlode: Methods in Womanist Ethics* (Pilgrim Press, 2006), *Deeper Shades of Purple: Womanism in Religion and Society* (New York University Press, 2006), *Black Church Studies: An Introduction* (Abingdon Press, 2007), *U. S. Liberation Theologies: An Introduction* (New York

University Press, 2010), and *Beyond the Pale: Reading Ethics from the Margins* (Westminster John Knox Press, 2011); and

WHEREAS, her current research projects, which continue to address the ongoing challenge of liberationist discourse and interdisciplinary scholarship, include *Exodus in America: The Unlikely Alliance between White Jews and Black Christians*; *Liberation Theologies in the United States: An Introduction*; *Making It Plain: Approaches to African American Christian Social Ethics*; and *The Westminster John Knox Dictionary of African American Religion and Thought*; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to awards and accolades, Dr. Floyd-Thomas received the Texas Christian University Chancellor's Award for Distinguished Achievement as a creative teacher and scholar; Brite Divinity School's Catherine Saylor Hill Faculty Excellence Award in Scholarship; the Louise Clark Brittan Faculty Excellence Award in Teaching; Virginia Tech's Diggs Teaching Scholar Award; Virginia Tech's College of Arts and Science Diversity Award; the J.P. Morgan Chase/Texas Business Press Great Women of Texas Award; the American Academy of Religion Excellence in Teaching Award; and the 2012 Womanist Legend Award; and

WHEREAS, a true asset to the Tennessee Ethics Commission during her years of service, Dr. Stacey Floyd-Thomas is passionate about her research, which seeks to address the challenge of constructing ethics to make liberationist discourse and theologies more viable; and

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that the members of this General Assembly pause to honor this extraordinary Tennessean on this occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Dr. Stacey Floyd-Thomas on her astute

service to the Tennessee Ethics Commission and thank her for her contributions to the citizens of this State, extending our best wishes for her every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.